government's debt/GDP ratio is only 46 per cent). Moreover, the debt is denominated in rupees and has an average maturity of more than nine years.

India's external debt burden is even more favourable, at only 21.2 per cent of GDP (much of it owed by the private sector), while short-term external debt is only 5.2 per cent of GDP. India's foreign-exchange reserves stand at $278 billion (about 15 per cent of GDP), enough to finance the entire current account deficit for several years. Even if you count all of trade credit as well as maturing deposits held by overseas Indians as short-term debt, India's reserves can pay them all down and still have money left over.

That said, India can do better – much better. The path to a more open, competitive, efficient, and humane economy will surely be bumpy in the years to come. But, in the short term, there is much low-hanging fruit to be plucked.

For instance, we are committed to developing our financial system, and carefully expanding access to finance can be a source of tremendous growth in the years to come. We are also embarked on large infrastructure projects. For example, the Delhi-Mumbai Industrial Corridor, a project with Japanese collaboration entailing over $90 billion in investment, will link Delhi to Mumbai's ports, covering an overall length of 1,483 km and passing through six states. This project will have nine mega industrial zones of about 200-250 sq. km., high speed freight lines, three ports, six airports, a six-lane intersection-free expressway connecting the country's political and financial capitals, and a 4,000 MW power plant. We have already seen a significant boost to economic activity as India built out the Golden Quadrilateral highway system, the boost from the Delhi-Mumbai Industrial Corridor can only be imagined. The best of India is yet to come.